# AI Primer : Training Curriculum — Recommended Learning Path

| Topic | Description & Importance | Overview (IBM) | Tutorial |
|---|---|---|---|
| **1. Foundational LLM Mechanics** | How AI works: Tools like ChatGPT and Gemini learn language patterns from vast amounts of training data. Rather than looking up answers, they respond word-by-word, statistically choosing the most likely next word. This drives their fluent, confident tone—even when wrong. Clear accurate user inputs, are essential to guiding its predictions towards accuracy. | 3Blue1Brown: Large Language Models Explained Briefly (~8 min)<br><br>IBM: How LLMs Work (~6 min) | IBM: Why LLMs Hallucinate (~10 min) |
| **2. Prompt Engineering** | Telling the AI who to act as, what exactly to do and which rules to follow. Precise wording and a clear role have more chance of getting the right answer first time; vague requests get vague results. | IBM: The Perfect Prompt (~13 min) | Prompt Engineering Course (~38 min) |
| **3. Context Engineering** | Giving the AI the right background information — the email chain, the client brief, the spreadsheet and other documents you are working from — and managing what it holds in view, keeps long conversations 'on topic' and stops it forgetting earlier instructions or inventing answers. | IBM: Context Windows (~12 min) | Context Engineering Course (~30 min) |
| **4. Microsoft Copilot** | AI built into Word, Excel, Outlook and Teams, so staff get the benefit inside the tools they already use every day. | Microsoft: Copilot Features Overview (~7 min) | Copilot in Word, Excel and PowerPoint (~17 min) |
| **5. Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG)** | Ask a question and the AI searches the information repositories — contracts, emails, procedures, project documents and more — then answers using what it found and names the document and page it came from. | IBM: What is RAG? (~7 min) | Any Document, Full Control, Full Privacy, Local - AnythingLLM (~15 min) |
| **6. AI Agents** | AI that carries out a job end to end, not just answers a question — useful for the repetitive multi-step tasks that eat up staff time.<br><br>Copilot Agents require information sources to be stored in Microsoft's cloud (e.g. documents, spreadsheets, email archives etc.). | IBM: What Are Agents? (~12 min) | Copilot Studio: Complete Tutorial for Beginners (~69 min)<br><br>Creating no-code AI AGENTS that run locally on your laptop \| AnythingLLM (~17 min) |

**RECOMMENDED: Complete the modules in order — each builds on the previous one.**